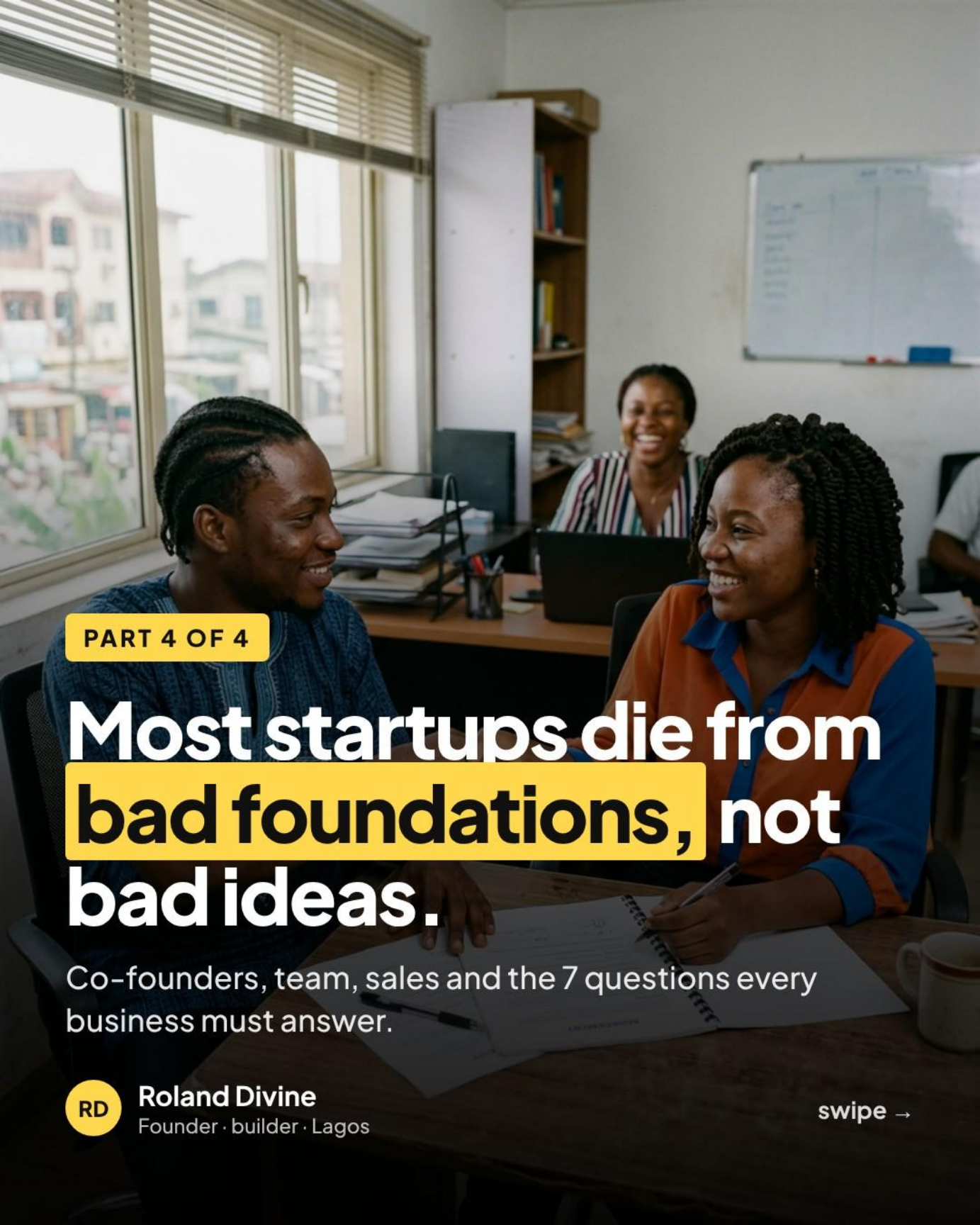


PART 4 OF 4

Most startups die from bad foundations, not bad ideas.

Co-founders, team, sales and the 7 questions every business must answer.

RD
Roland Divine
Founder · builder · Lagos

swipe →

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Choose co-founders carefully

- Start with people you have real history with.
- Agree early, in writing: who owns what, who decides what, and who works full-time.

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Build a tight team

- Hire people who'd love working together, on a mission they believe in.
- Give each person one clear job, so they're not fighting over the same work.



Sales matters as much as product

- "Build it and they will come" is a myth.
- If you can't reach customers at a cost you can afford, a great product still dies.



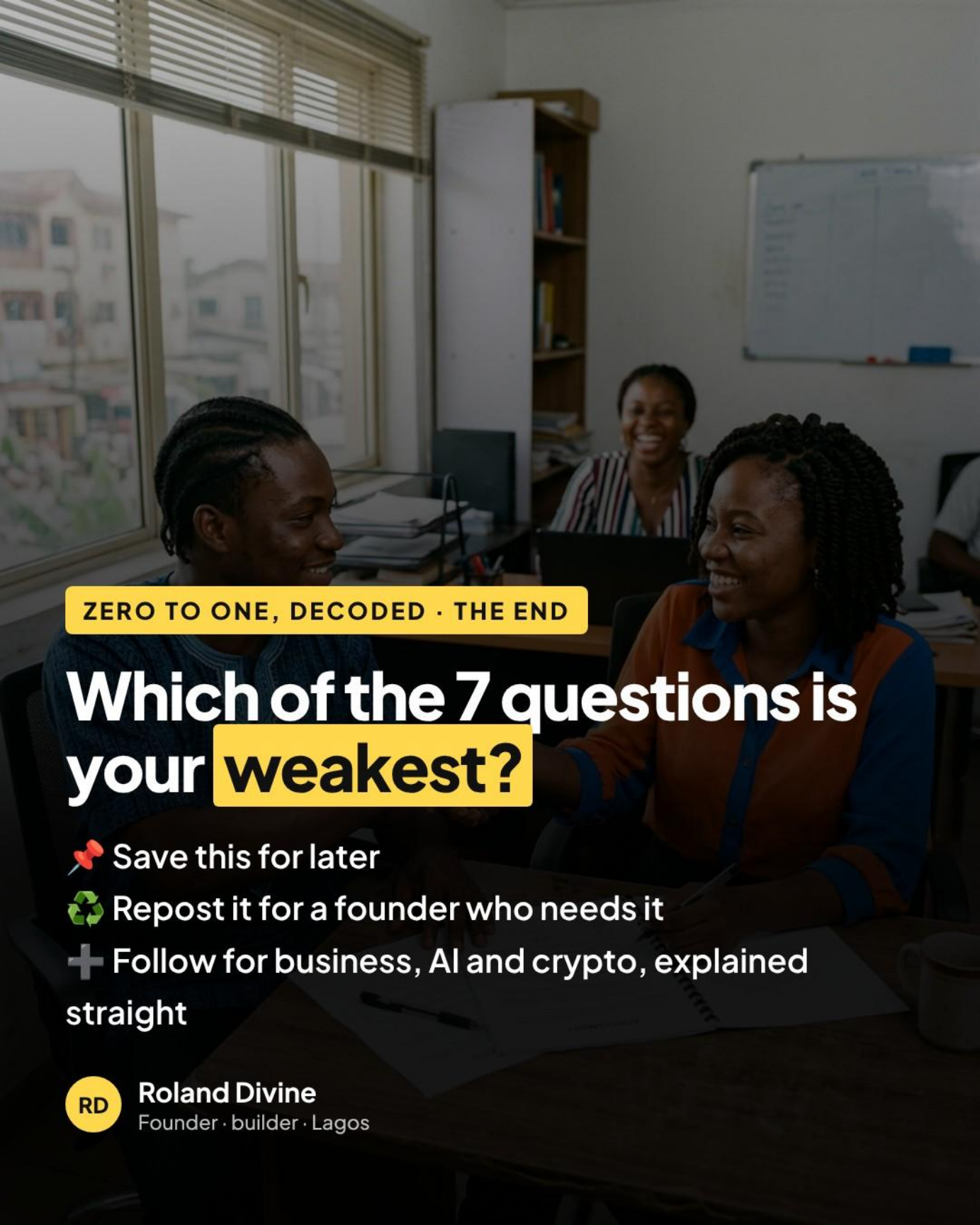
Match sales to deal size

- Big contracts: the founder in the room, selling personally.
- Small purchases: marketing, referrals, word of mouth. The middle is the hardest place to be.

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The 7 questions

- **Engineering:** 10× better?
- **Timing:** why now?
- **Monopoly:** a big share of a small market?
- **People:** the right team?
- **Distribution:** how will you sell?
- **Durability:** still here in 10 years?
- **Secret:** what do you see that others don't?


ZERO TO ONE, DECODED · THE END
Which of the 7 questions is your weakest?
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